



DELHI | Dead Heat

Central India's scorching heat is killing animals in the wild. About 200 simians have died in Tadoba Tiger Reserve due to a lack of water during this brutal summer. Dehydrated langurs are fighting for their lives in the reserve's Sindewahi tehsil, a tiger family is going without water in Tadoba's buffer zone and a desperate Forest Department has pressed four tankers to transport water from the Tadoba, Telia or Kolsa lakes to refill the reserve's dried up watering holes. Nirmalya Chakraborty, tiger activist and wildlife conservationist who was part of the rescue operation, says, "The park needs to be augmented with capable staff to effectively implement wildlife protection, ecotourism and other projects. Tiger protection being the priority, other issues are not addressed adequately." Ironical that urban India's common cure, the tanker, is now going wild.

by Mihir Srivastava

MUMBAI | Box Populi

Mumbai Metro trains will have something their counterparts in Delhi and Kolkata don't: a black box. Similar to the black box on airplanes, these crash-proof data recorders will be fitted in each of the four coaches of the trains. The trains will also be equipped with CCTVs and a passenger-driver communication system.

Office Alert

Officials of the Brihanmumbai Municipal Corporation occupy 156 buildings described as dangerous urban structures. by Nishat Bari

BANGALORE | Powering Up

Six months after the launch of the National Solar Mission, New and Renewable Energy Minister Farooq Abdullah will formally switch on India's biggest solar photovoltaic plant. The 3-megawatt solar power plant in Yellandandra village, 80 km east of Bangalore, comprises 13,300 solar panels, each with a 23-watt capacity. The Karnataka Power Corporation's 15-acre, Rs 59-crore plant can generate half-a-million units every month in summer, enough to light up 20 villages. The National Solar Mission targets 20,000 MW by 2022. Experts say a million solar lights will save five lakh litres of kerosene. "This is the first step to making solar energy popular in our state," says Additional Chief Secretary (Energy) K. Jairaj.

by Stephen David

THE RS 59-CRORE SOLAR PLANT CAN GENERATE ENOUGH POWER TO LIGHT UP 20 VILLAGES IN SUMMER AND WILL GENERATE 20,000 MW BY 2022.

PUNE CITIZENS MAY SOON BE ALLOWED TO 'ADOPT' THE ZOO'S TIGERS AND ELEPHANTS.

MUMBAI | Adoption Gone Wild

If all goes well, anyone will be able to adopt tigers for Rs 49.27 lakh, elephants for Rs 18.25 lakh or leopards for Rs 14.60 lakh. That is, if a proposal by the Rajiv Gandhi Zoological Park is passed by the Pune civic body. It will give citizens the right to contribute money for food and health for its zoo animals for one to five years. The adopter will not be able to touch the animals nor enter their enclosure. Citizens will be allowed to adopt whole enclosures or a particular species. Mumbai's civic body too has been toying with the idea. "We have studied the animal adoption schemes of the zoos in Lucknow, Mysore and Ahmedabad before proposing the idea," says Kazveen Umrigar, director, Rajiv Gandhi Zoological Park.

by Mitali Patel



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